Periodic Traveling Waves in an Integro-Difference Equation With a Non-Monotone Growth Function and Strong Allee Effect

Michael Nestor and Bingtuan Li*

Department of Mathematics, University of Louisville
Louisville, KY 40292

Abstract

We derive sufficient conditions for the existence of a periodic traveling wave solution to an integro-difference equation with a piecewise constant growth function exhibiting a stable period-2 cycle and strong Allee effect. The mean traveling wave speed is shown to be the asymptotic spreading speed of solutions with compactly supported initial data under appropriate conditions. We then conduct case studies for the Laplace kernel and uniform kernel.

Key words: Integro-difference equation, period two cycle, Allee effect, periodic traveling wave.

AMS Subject Classification: 92D40, 92D25.

1 Introduction

Integro-difference equations in the form

$$u_{n+1}(x) \;=\; Q[u_n](x) \;:=\; \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} k(x-y)\, g\left(u_n(y)\right)\, \mathrm{d}y \tag{1.1}$$

are of great interest in the studies of invasions of populations with discrete generations and separate growth and dispersal stages. They have been used to predict changes in gene frequency [8, 9, 10, 14, 17], and applied to ecological problems [2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 11, 12, 13]. Previous rigorous studies on integro-difference equations have assumed that the growth function is nondecreasing [17, 18], or is non-monotone without Allee effect [10, 16]. The results show existence of constant spreading speeds and travelng waves with fixed shapes and speeds. Sullivan et al. [15] demonstrated numerically that an integro-difference equation with a non-monotone growth function exhibiting a strong Allee effect can generate traveling waves with fluctuating speeds, and Otto [13] showed that such an equation can have robust non-spreading solutions. In this paper we give conditions for the existence of a periodic traveling wave with two intermediate speeds for an integro-difference equation with a piecewise constant growth function that exhibits a strong Allee effect and a period-2 cycle.

Piecewise constant growth functions have been used in the studies of integro-difference equations; see for example [6, 11, 13, 15]. Such an equation is analytically tractable and it can provide

*M. Nestor's email is mdnest01@gmail.com. B. Li was partially supported by the National Science Foundation under Grant DMS-1515875 and Grant DMS-1951482.

specific insights into the dynamics of solutions. For the piecewise constant growth function

$$g(u) = \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } u < a, \\ 1, & \text{if } u \geq a, \end{cases} \tag{1.2}$$

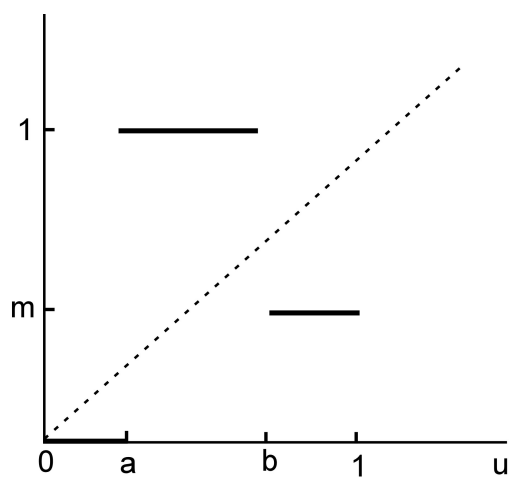
with $0 < a < 1$, which exhibits a strong Allee effect and monotonicity, Kot et al. [6] and Lutscher [11] (Section 6.1) investigated the range expansion of the population and the spreading speed, and Sullivan et al. [15] studied oscillations in spreading speeds when the dispersal kernel is density dependent. More discussions about integro-difference equations with piecewise growth functions can be found in Lutscher [11] (Chapter 15).

In this paper, we consider the integro-difference equation (1.1) with

$$g(u) = \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } u < a, \\ 1, & \text{if } a \leq u \leq b, \\ m, & \text{if } u > b, \end{cases} \tag{1.3}$$

with $0 < a < m < b < 1$. $g(u)$ is a piecewise constant non-monotone growth function exhibiting a strong Allee effect [1]. Specifically, it has a stable fixed point at zero and a stable period two cycle $(1, m)$ with a the Allee threshold value. This is the function considered in Otto [13] where non-spreading solitions are studied. It may be viewed as an extension of (1.2). A graphical demonstration of g defined by (1.3) is given by Figure 1. We rigorously construct periodic traveling waves

Figure 1: The growth of $g(u)$ defined by (1.3) with $0 < a < m < b < 1$.



with two intermediate speed for (1.1) with g given by (1.3) and a proper dispersal kernel k. To the best of our knowledge, this is the first time that traveling waves with oscillating speeds have been analytically established for scalar spatiotemporal equations with constant parameters. We also show that the mean traveling wave speed is the spreading speed of solutions with compactly supported initial data under appropriate conditions. We finally conduct case studies for the Laplace kernel and uniform kernel.

2 Results

In this section, we present our main results about our model. Throughout, we assume all population density functions are bounded elements of $C(\mathbb{R})$, the space of real-valued continuous functions. It

is straightforward to verify this space is closed under iteration of Q. We denote the norm of a function $u \in C(\mathbb{R})$ by $||u||_\infty$.

We make the following assumptions about the dispersal kernel.

Hypothesis 2.1. $k(x)$ is a piecewise differentiable function satisfying

(H1) $k(x) \geq 0$ for all x, and $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} k(x)\,\mathrm{d}x = 1$,

(H2) $k(x) = k(-x)$ for all x,

(H3) $k(x) > 0$ for all $x \in (-\sigma, \sigma)$ for some $0 < \sigma \leq \infty$,

(H4) for all $\lambda \in (0,1)$, for all $A, B \in \mathbb{R}$ with $A > B$, the expression

$$k(x-A) - \lambda k(x-B)$$

has < 2 sign changes, and

(H5) for all $\lambda \in (0,1)$, for all $A, B \in \mathbb{R}$ with $A > B$, the expression

$$k(x-r-A) - \lambda k(x-r-B) - k(x+r+A) + \lambda k(x+r+B)$$

has < 4 sign changes for sufficiently large $r > 0$.

2.1 Periodic traveling waves

Let $w_1, w_2 \in C(\mathbb{R})$ be bounded, continuous functions defined by

$$w_1(x) := \int_x^{\infty} k(y)\,\mathrm{d}y \tag{2.1}$$

and

$$w_2(x) := Q[w_1](x + c^*) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} k(x + c^* - y) g(w_1(y))\,\mathrm{d}y \tag{2.2}$$

where c^* is a constant defined by

$$c^* := \frac{1}{2} \sup\{x \in \mathbb{R} \mid Q[w_1](x) = a\}. \tag{2.3}$$

The following theorem shows that w_1 and w_2 generate a traveling wave-like solution to (1.1). We term this solution a *periodic traveling wave* since it alternates between two distinct wave profiles (with different limits at $-\infty$) while traveling with mean speed c^*.

Theorem 2.2. Let $(W_n)_{n=0}^{\infty}$ be a sequence of bounded, continuous functions defined by

$$W_n(x) := \begin{cases} w_1(x - nc^*), & n \text{ even}, \\ w_2(x - nc^*), & n \text{ odd}. \end{cases} \tag{2.4}$$

If $||w_2||_\infty < b$, then $W_{n+1} = Q[W_n]$ for all $n \geq 0$.

Proof. For $i = 1, 2$, define the right inverse of w_i by

$$\Phi_i(\ell) := \sup\{x \in \mathbb{R} \mid w_i(x) = \ell\}, \quad i = 1, 2. \tag{2.5}$$

Note that $\Phi_i(\ell)$ is finite for $0 < \ell < ||w_i||_\infty$, where $||w_1||_\infty = 1$, and $a < ||w_2||_\infty < b$ by the assumption of this theorem.

By the translation invariance property of Q, it suffices to show

$$Q[w_1](x) = w_2(x - c^*) \tag{2.6}$$

and

$$Q[w_2](x) = w_1(x - c^*) \tag{2.7}$$

for all $x \in \mathbb{R}$. The first equation follows immediately from definition (2.2). To prove the second, observe that w_1 is monotonically decreasing and satisfies $w_1(\infty) = 0$ and $w_1(-\infty) = 1$ (see for example Figure 2). Thus,

$$g(w_1(x)) = \begin{cases} m, & x < \Phi_1(b), \\ 1, & \Phi_1(b) \le x \le \Phi_1(a), \\ 0, & x > \Phi_1(a). \end{cases}$$

Applying the integro-difference operator yields

$$\begin{aligned} w_2(x - c^*) &= Q[w_1](x) \\ &= m \int_{-\infty}^{\Phi_1(b)} k(x - y)\,\mathrm{d}y + \int_{\Phi_1(b)}^{\Phi_1(a)} k(x - y)\,\mathrm{d}y \\ &= w_1(x - \Phi_1(a)) - (1 - m)\, w_1(x - \Phi_1(b)). \end{aligned}$$

We can then differentiate with respect to x:

$$\left.\frac{\mathrm{d}w_2}{\mathrm{d}x}\right|_{x - c^*} = -k(x - \Phi_1(a)) + (1 - m)\, k(x - \Phi_1(b)).$$

From (H4), $\frac{\mathrm{d}w_2}{\mathrm{d}x}$ has at most 1 sign change; thus, w_2 has at most 1 turning point. We also have $w_2(x) < b$ for all x, hence $g(w_2(x)) \in \{0, 1\}$.

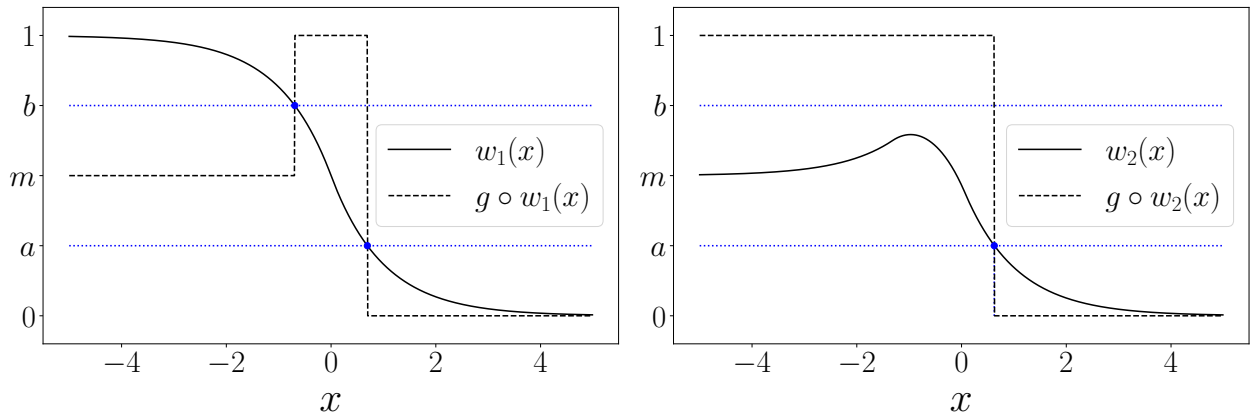
We claim

$$g(w_2(x)) = \begin{cases} 1, & x \le c^*, \\ 0, & x > c^*, \end{cases} \tag{2.8}$$

where c^* is defined by (2.3). This can be shown by arguing in cases depending on the number of turning points of w_2.

Case 1. If w_2 has no turning points, then w_2 is monotone decreasing with $0 \le w_2(x) \le m$ for all x. It follows by the intermediate value theorem (IVT) that $c^* = \Phi_2(a)$ satisfies (2.8).

Case 2. If w_2 has one turning point, say $x_0 \in \mathbb{R}$, then w_2 must be increasing for $x < x_0$ and decreasing for $x > x_0$. It follows that x_0 is a global maximum, and w_2 is increasing on $(-\infty, x_0)$ and decreasing on (x_0, ∞). We have $g(w_2(x)) = 1$ for $x < x_0$. By the IVT, $c^* = \Phi_2(a)$ is the unique solution to (2.8).



(a) $w_1(x)$ (b) $w_2(x)$

Figure 2: Profiles of the intermediate traveling waves w_1 and w_2, with $k(x)$ equal to the Laplace kernel (see Section 3). Blue points mark the intersection of the curves with the level sets $\ell = a$ and $\ell = b$.

Taking the convolution of equation (2.8) with $k(x)$ yields

$$Q[w_2](x) \;=\; \int_{-\infty}^{c^*} k(x-y)\,\mathrm{d}y \;=\; w_1(x-c^*).$$

This completes the proof. □

Theorem 2.2 describes a rightward periodic traveling wave, but we can define the corresponding leftward periodic traveling wave via $x \mapsto W_n(-x)$. This is due to the fact that Q is symmetric and translation invariant.

We investigated the intermediate wave speed generated by the periodic traveling wave solution (2.4). To do this, we define a sequence $(\xi_n)_{n=0}^{\infty}$ of continuous functions $(0,m) \to \mathbb{R}$ by

$$\xi_n(\ell) := \sup\{x \in \mathbb{R} : W_n(x) = \ell\}, \quad \ell \in (0,m). \tag{2.9}$$

This expression yields the rightmost intersection of the curve $u = W_n(x)$ with the horizontal line $u = \ell$. By computing the first difference, we obtain a new function sequence $(c_n)_{n=0}^{\infty}$ (with the same domain and range) defined by

$$c_n(\ell) := \xi_{n+1}(\ell) - \xi_n(\ell), \quad \ell \in (0,m). \tag{2.10}$$

From Theorem 2.2, we have that $c_n(\ell)$ converges to a period-2 cycle for every $\ell \in (0,m)$.

Our results about the intermediate wave speed sequence are summarized in the following corollary.

Corollary 2.3. Assume the hypothesis of Theorem 2.2 holds. Then for all $\ell \in (0,m)$, the sequence $c_n(\ell)$ satisfies

$$c_n(\ell) = c^* + \begin{cases} \Phi_1(\ell) - \Phi_2(\ell), & n \text{ even}, \\ \Phi_2(\ell) - \Phi_1(\ell), & n \text{ odd}. \end{cases} \tag{2.11}$$

Proof. By Theorem 2.2, we have

$$\begin{aligned}\xi_n(\ell) &= \begin{cases}\sup\{x \in \mathbb{R} \mid w_1(x - nc^*) = \ell\}, & n \text{ even},\\ \sup\{x \in \mathbb{R} \mid w_2(x - nc^*) = \ell\}, & n \text{ odd},\end{cases}\\ &= nc^* + \begin{cases}\Phi_1(\ell), & n \text{ even},\\ \Phi_2(\ell), & n \text{ odd}.\end{cases}\end{aligned}$$

for every $\ell \in (0, m)$. Taking the first difference yields

$$\begin{aligned}c_n(\ell) &= \xi_n(\ell) - \xi_{n-1}(\ell)\\ &= nc^* + \begin{cases}\Phi_1(\ell), & n \text{ even},\\ \Phi_2(\ell), & n \text{ odd},\end{cases} - (n-1)\, c^* + \begin{cases}\Phi_2(\ell), & n \text{ even},\\ \Phi_1(\ell), & n \text{ odd},\end{cases}\\ &= c^* + \begin{cases}\Phi_1(\ell) - \Phi_2(\ell), & n \text{ even},\\ \Phi_2(\ell) - \Phi_1(\ell), & n \text{ odd}.\end{cases}\end{aligned}$$

□

Thus, for each fixed $\ell \in (0, m)$, we can define intermediate traveling wave speeds c_1^* and c_2^* by

$$c_1^*(\ell) := c^* + \Phi_1(\ell) - \Phi_2(\ell) \tag{2.12}$$

and

$$c_2^*(\ell) := c^* + \Phi_2(\ell) - \Phi_1(\ell). \tag{2.13}$$

It follows that (1.1) has a periodic traveling wave with wave profiles $w_1(x)$ and $w_2(x)$, intermediate wave speeds $c_1^*(\ell)$ and $c_2^*(\ell)$, and mean wave speed $\frac{1}{2}\left(c_1^*(\ell) + c_2^*(\ell)\right) = c^*$. Note that the intermediate wave speeds depend on ℓ, but their sum is identically equal to $2c^*$.

2.2 Periodic spreading solutions

By applying the results of Theorem 2.2, we were able to prove the asymptotic spreading speed of solutions with compact initial data. In particular, we showed that c^* is the asymptotic spreading speed of compactly supported initial data with sufficient weight above the Allee threshold but below the overcompensation threshold.

Theorem 2.4. Assume the hypothesis of Theorem 2.2 holds. Suppose $u \in C(\mathbb{R})$ is bounded, non-negative, and has compact support. If

i. $||u||_\infty < b$,

ii. the set $A := \{x \in \mathbb{R} : u(x) \geq a\}$ is connected and has sufficiently large length, and

iii. $c^* > 0$,

then the sequence $(u_n)_{n=0}^\infty$ defined by $u_0 = u$ and $u_{n+1} = Q[u_n]$ for $n \geq 0$ spreads asymptotically with mean speed c^*.

Proof. We define two continuous functions $\tilde{w_1}, \tilde{w_2} : \mathbb{R} \times [0, \infty) \to \mathbb{R}$ by

$$\tilde{w_1}(x, r) := w_1(x) - w_1(x + 2r) = \int_{-2r}^{0} k(x - y)\, \mathrm{d}y \tag{2.14}$$

and

$$\tilde{w_2}(x,r) := Q[\tilde{w_1}(\,\cdot\,,r)](x+c^*). \tag{2.15}$$

Observe that $\tilde{w_1}$ is symmetric with respect to $x=-r$, and $\tilde{w_2}$ is symmetric with respect to $x=-r-c^*$. This notation can be justified by observing that $\tilde{w_1}(x,r)\to w_1(x)$ and $\tilde{w_2}(x,r)\to w_2(x)$ as $r\to\infty$ for all x. We also set

$$\phi_i(r,\ell) := \sup\{x\in\mathbb{R} \mid \tilde{w}_i(x,r)=\ell\}, \quad i=1,2. \tag{2.16}$$

ϕ_1 and ϕ_2 are the right-inverse of $\tilde{w_1}$ and $\tilde{w_2}$, respectively. For a fixed $r>0$, the value of $\phi_i(r,\ell)$ is finite if $0<\ell<||\tilde{w}_i(\,\cdot\,,r)||_\infty$, with the latter bound converging to $||w_i||_\infty$ as $r\to\infty$. They satisfy

$$\lim_{r\to\infty}\phi_i(r,\ell)=\Phi_i(\ell), \quad 0<\ell<||w_i||_\infty, \quad i=1,2.$$

We now apply the growth function to $\tilde{w_1}$, assuming r is sufficiently large enough so that $a<||\tilde{w_1}(\,\cdot\,,r)||_\infty<b$; this is guaranteed by taking $r>\Phi_1\left(\frac{1-a}{2}\right)$. We have

$$g\left(\tilde{w_1}(x,r)\right)=\begin{cases}0, & x<-2r-\phi_1(r,a),\\ 1, & -2r-\phi_1(r,a)<x<-2r-\phi_1(r,b),\\ m, & -2r-\phi_1(r,b)<x<\phi_1(r,b),\\ 1, & \phi_1(r,b)<x<\phi_1(r,a),\\ 0, & \phi_1(r,a)<x.\end{cases}$$

Note that the above expression converges to $g(w_1(x))$ as $r\to\infty$ for all x. We then apply the convolution operator:

$$\begin{aligned}\tilde{w_2}(x-c^*,r)=Q[\tilde{w_1}(\,\cdot\,,r)](x) &= \int_{-2r-\phi_1(r,a)}^{\phi_1(r,a)} k(x-y)\,\mathrm{d}y-(1-m)\int_{-2r-\phi_1(r,b)}^{\phi_1(r,b)} k(x-y)\,\mathrm{d}y\\ &= w_1(x-\phi_1(r,a))-(1-m)\,w_1(x-\phi_1(r,b))\\ &\quad+(1-m)\,w_1(x+2r+\phi_1(r,b))-w_1(x+2r+\phi_1(r,a)).\end{aligned}$$

Computing the derivative of this expression yields

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\mathrm{d}\tilde{w_2}}{\mathrm{d}x}\Big|_{x-c^*} &= -k(x-\phi_1(r,a))+(1-m)\,k(x-\phi_1(r,b))\\ &\quad-(1-m)\,k(x+2r+\phi_1(r,b))+k(x+2r+\phi_1(r,a)).\end{aligned}$$

By (H5), the number of turning points of $\tilde{w_2}$ is at most 3 (assuming r is sufficiently large). Furthermore, $\tilde{w_2}$ is symmetric around $x=-r-c^*$; thus the sign changes must come in pairs or occur exactly at $x=-r-c^*$. We can immediately exclude the cases of 0 and 2 turning points because $\tilde{w_2}$ is non-negative, vanishes at $\pm\infty$, and is not identically zero. As in the proof of Theorem 2.2, this leaves two cases:

Case 1. If $\tilde{w_2}$ has 1 turning point, then it must occur at $x=-r-c^*$. We have $\tilde{w_2}(-r-c^*,r)=w_2(-r-c^*)-w_2(r+c^*)\to m$ as $r\to\infty$; hence, it is sufficient to take r large enough so that $|\tilde{w_2}(-r-c^*,r)-m|<\min\{|a-m|,|b-m|\}$. It follows by the triangle inequality that $\tilde{w_2}(x,r)\le\tilde{w_2}(-r-c^*,r)<b$ for all x.

Case 2. If $\tilde{w_2}$ has 3 turning points, then again by symmetry, they must be given by $\{-r-c^*-t, -r-c^*, -r-c^*+t\}$, for some $t>0$. We can label them in increasing order by $t_1 < t_2 < t_3$. It follows that t_1 and t_3 are maxima with $\tilde{w_2}(t_1,r) = \tilde{w_2}(t_3,r) \to ||w_2||_\infty$ as $r \to \infty$, and t_2 is a local minima with $\tilde{w_2}(t_2,r) \to m$ as $r \to \infty$. Thus $\tilde{w_2}$ is monotone increasing on $(-\infty, t_1) \cup (t_2, t_3)$ and monotone decreasing on $(t_1, t_2) \cup (t_3, \infty)$. By taking r sufficiently large, we can make $|\tilde{w_2}(t_1,r) - ||w_2||_\infty| = |\tilde{w_2}(t_3,r) - ||w_2||_\infty| < |b - ||w_2||_\infty|$ and $|\tilde{w_2}(t_2,r) - m| < |a-m|$.

In both cases, we have $a \le \tilde{w_2}(x,r) \le b$ on a closed interval of radius $r + c^* + \phi_2(r,a)$ and $\tilde{w_2}(x,r) < a$ elsewhere. Taking composition with g yields

$$g(\tilde{w_2}(x-c^*,r)) = \begin{cases} 0, & x < -2r - c^* - \phi_2(r,a), \\ 1, & -2r - c^* - \phi_2(r,a) \le x \le c^* + \phi_2(r,a), \\ 0, & x > c^* + \phi_2(r,a). \end{cases}$$

Hence,

$$Q^2[\tilde{w_1}(\,\cdot\,,r)](x) = w_1(x - c^* - \phi_2(r,a)) - w_1(x + 2r + c^* + \phi_2(r,a)).$$

Shifting the expression left by $c^* + \phi_2(r,a)$ units yields

$$Q^2[\tilde{w_1}(\,\cdot\,,r)](x + c^* + \phi_2(r,a)) = \tilde{w_1}(x, r + c^* + \phi_2(r,a)). \tag{2.17}$$

We are now prepared to prove the theorem using an inductive argument. Let A be the level set defined in the statement of the theorem. Without loss of generality, we write $A = [-r_0, r_0]$, for some $r_0 > 0$. We have

$$g(u_0(x)) = \begin{cases} 1, & -r_0 \le x \le r_0, \\ 0, & \text{else.} \end{cases}$$

for all x. Applying the convolution operator yields

$$\begin{aligned} u_1(x) &= w_1(x - r_0) - w_1(x + r_0) \\ &= \tilde{w_1}(x - r_0, r_0). \end{aligned}$$

Let $(r_n)_{n=0}^\infty$ be a sequence of real numbers satisfying

$$r_{n+1} = r_n + c^* + \phi_2(r_n, a). \tag{2.18}$$

If r_0 is sufficiently large, we can show that r_n is strictly increasing and unbounded. This is due to our assumption that $c^* > 0$. Since $\phi_2(r,a) \to c^*$, it suffices to assume $|\phi_2(r,a) - c^*| < c^*$, i.e. r_0 is sufficieintly large so that $\phi_2(r,a) > 0$ for all $r > r_0$. Plugging this into the recurrence (2.18) yields $r_{n+1} - r_n = c^* + \phi_2(r,a) > c^* > 0$.

This argument shows that, assuming r_0 is sufficiently large, equation (2.17) may be applied recursively. From the principle of induction, it follows that $u_{2n+1}(x) = \tilde{w_1}(x - r_n, r_n)$ for all $n \ge 0$. Knowing that (r_n) is unbounded allows us to use equation (2.18) to compute the asymptotic spreading speed as the following limit.

$$\lim_{n\to\infty}(r_{n+1} - r_n) = \lim_{n\to\infty}(c^* + \phi_2(r_n,a)) = c^* + \lim_{r\to\infty}\phi_2(r,a) = 2c^*.$$

This completes the proof. □

3 Examples

In this section, we construct the periodic traveling wave solution for uniform and Laplace kernels and derive formulas for the mean spreading speed c^* in terms of the model parameters. We verify our results using numerical simulation, with source code available at `https://github.com/mdnestor/ide-ptws`.

3.1 Laplace kernel

We applied our main results to the Laplace dispersal kernel, defined

$$k(x) = \frac{1}{2}e^{-|x|}. \tag{3.1}$$

$k(x)$ is symmetric and has connected support, satisfying (H1), (H2), and (H3). We will now prove that $k(x)$ satisfies (H5). Let $A, B \in \mathbb{R}$ with $A > B$, let $\lambda \in (0,1)$, and define $f(x) = k(x-A) - \lambda k(x-B)$. For $r > 0$ sufficiently large, we have

$$f(x-r) - f(-x-r) = k(x-r-A) - \lambda k(x-r-B) - k(x+r+A) + \lambda k(x+r+B)$$

$$= \begin{cases} \frac{1}{2}e^{x}\left(-e^{r+A} + me^{r+B} - me^{-r-B} + e^{-r-A}\right), & x < -r-A, \\ \frac{1}{2}e^{-x-r-A} + \frac{1}{2}e^{x}\left(e^{-r-A} - me^{-r-B} + me^{r+B}\right), & -r-A \le x \le -r-B, \\ \frac{1}{2}e^{-x}\left(-e^{-r-A} + me^{-r-B}\right) + \frac{1}{2}e^{x}\left(-me^{-r-B} + e^{-r-A}\right), & -r-B < x < r+B, \\ \frac{1}{2}e^{-x}\left(-e^{-r-A} + me^{-r-B} - me^{r+B}\right) + \frac{1}{2}e^{x-r-A}, & r+B \le x \le r+A \\ e^{-x}\left(-e^{-r-A} + me^{-r-B} - me^{r+B} + e^{r+A}\right), & x > r+A. \end{cases}$$

f is monotone on $(-\infty, -r-A) \cup (r+A, \infty)$ with $f(\pm\infty) = 0$; thus it cannot have any sign changes there. On each of the intervals $[-r-A, -r-B]$, $(-r-B, r+B)$, and $[r+B, r+A]$, f has the form $Ce^{x} + De^{-x}$. Depending on the sign of C and D, f can have either one or zero sign changes on each interval. Summing over each interval, it follows that f has at most 3 sign changes. This proves (H5); the proof of (H4) follows a similar argument.

Assuming $||w_2||_\infty < b$, the periodic traveling wave profiles are given by

$$w_1(x) = \begin{cases} 1 - \frac{1}{2}e^{x}, & \text{if } x \le 0, \\ \frac{1}{2}e^{-x}, & \text{if } x > 0, \end{cases} \tag{3.2}$$

and

$$w_2(x-c^*) = \begin{cases} m + \left(\frac{1}{2}(1-m)e^{-\Phi_1(b)} - \frac{1}{2}e^{-\Phi_1(a)}\right)e^{x}, & x < \Phi_1(b), \\ 1 - \frac{1}{2}e^{-\Phi_1(a)}e^{x} - \frac{1}{2}(1-m)e^{\Phi_1(b)}e^{-x}, & \Phi_1(b) \le x \le \Phi_1(a), \\ \left(\frac{1}{2}e^{\Phi_1(a)} - \frac{1}{2}(1-m)e^{\Phi_1(b)}\right)e^{-x}, & \Phi_1(a) < x, \end{cases} \tag{3.3}$$

with

$$c^* = \frac{1}{2}\log\begin{cases} \frac{1}{2a}\left(e^{\Phi_1(a)} - (1-m)e^{\Phi_1(b)}\right), & a \le \ell_a, \\ e^{\Phi_1(a)}\left(1 - a + \sqrt{(1-a)^2 - (1-m)e^{\Phi_1(b)-\Phi_1(a)}}\right), & \ell_a < a < \ell_b, \\ 2\,(m-a)\left[e^{-\Phi_1(a)} - (1-m)e^{-\Phi_1(b)}\right]^{-1}, & a \ge \ell_b. \end{cases} \tag{3.4}$$

ℓ_a and ℓ_b are constants given by

$$\ell_a = \frac{1}{2}\left(1 - (1-m)e^{\Phi_1(b)-\Phi_1(a)}\right), \quad \ell_b = \frac{1}{2}\left(1 + m - e^{\Phi_1(b)-\Phi_1(a)}\right). \tag{3.5}$$

The formulas for Φ_1 and Φ_2 are given by

$$\Phi_1(\ell) = \begin{cases} -\log(2\ell), & \ell \le \frac{1}{2}, \\ \log(2-2\ell), & \ell > \frac{1}{2}, \end{cases} \tag{3.6}$$

and

$$\Phi_2(\ell) = -c^* + \log \begin{cases} \frac{1}{2\ell}\left(e^{\Phi_1(a)} - (1-m)e^{\Phi_1(b)}\right), & \ell \le w_2(\Phi_1(a)), \\ e^{\Phi_1(a)}\left(1-\ell+\sqrt{(1-\ell)^2-(1-m)e^{\Phi_1(b)-\Phi_1(a)}}\right), & w_2(\Phi_1(a)) < \ell < w_2(\Phi_1(b)), \\ 2\,(m-\ell)\left[e^{-\Phi_1(a)} - (1-m)e^{-\Phi_1(b)}\right]^{-1}, & \ell \ge w_2(\Phi_1(b)). \end{cases} \tag{3.7}$$

The critical spreading speed c^* for the Laplace kernel thus falls into one of three cases:

Case 1. $a \le \frac{1}{2}$, $b \le \frac{1}{2}$:

$$c^* = \frac{1}{2}\log \begin{cases} \frac{b-a(1-m)}{4a^2 b}, & a < \frac{b-a(1-m)}{2b}, \\ \frac{1-a+\sqrt{b(1-a)^2-a(1-m)}}{2a\sqrt{b}}, & \frac{b-a(1-m)}{2b} \le a \le \frac{b(1+m)-a}{2b}, \\ \frac{a-m}{b(1-m)-a}, & a > \frac{b(1+m)-a}{2b}. \end{cases}$$

Case 2. $a \le \frac{1}{2}$, $b > \frac{1}{2}$:

$$c^* = \frac{1}{2}\log \begin{cases} \frac{1-4a(1-m)(1-b)}{4a^2}, & a < \frac{1-4a(1-m)(1-b)}{2}, \\ \frac{1-a+\sqrt{(1-a)^2-4a(1-m)(1-b)}}{2a}, & \frac{1-4a(1-m)(1-b)}{2} \le a \le \frac{1+m-4a(1-b)}{2}, \\ \frac{4(a-m)(1-b)}{1-m-4a(1-b)}, & a > \frac{1+m-4a(1-b)}{2}. \end{cases}$$

Case 3. $a > \frac{1}{2}$, $b > \frac{1}{2}$:

$$c^* = \frac{1}{2}\log \begin{cases} \frac{1-a-(1-m)(1-b)}{a}, & a < \frac{1-a-(1-m)(1-b)}{2(1-a)}, \\ 2\,(1-a)\left(1-a+\sqrt{\frac{(1-a)^3-(1-m)(1-b)}{1-a}}\right), & \frac{1-a-(1-m)(1-b)}{2(1-a)} \le a \le \frac{b-1+m(1-a)}{2(1-a)}, \\ \frac{4(m-a)(1-a)(1-b)}{1-b+m(1-a)}, & a > \frac{b-1+m(1-a)}{2(1-a)}. \end{cases}$$

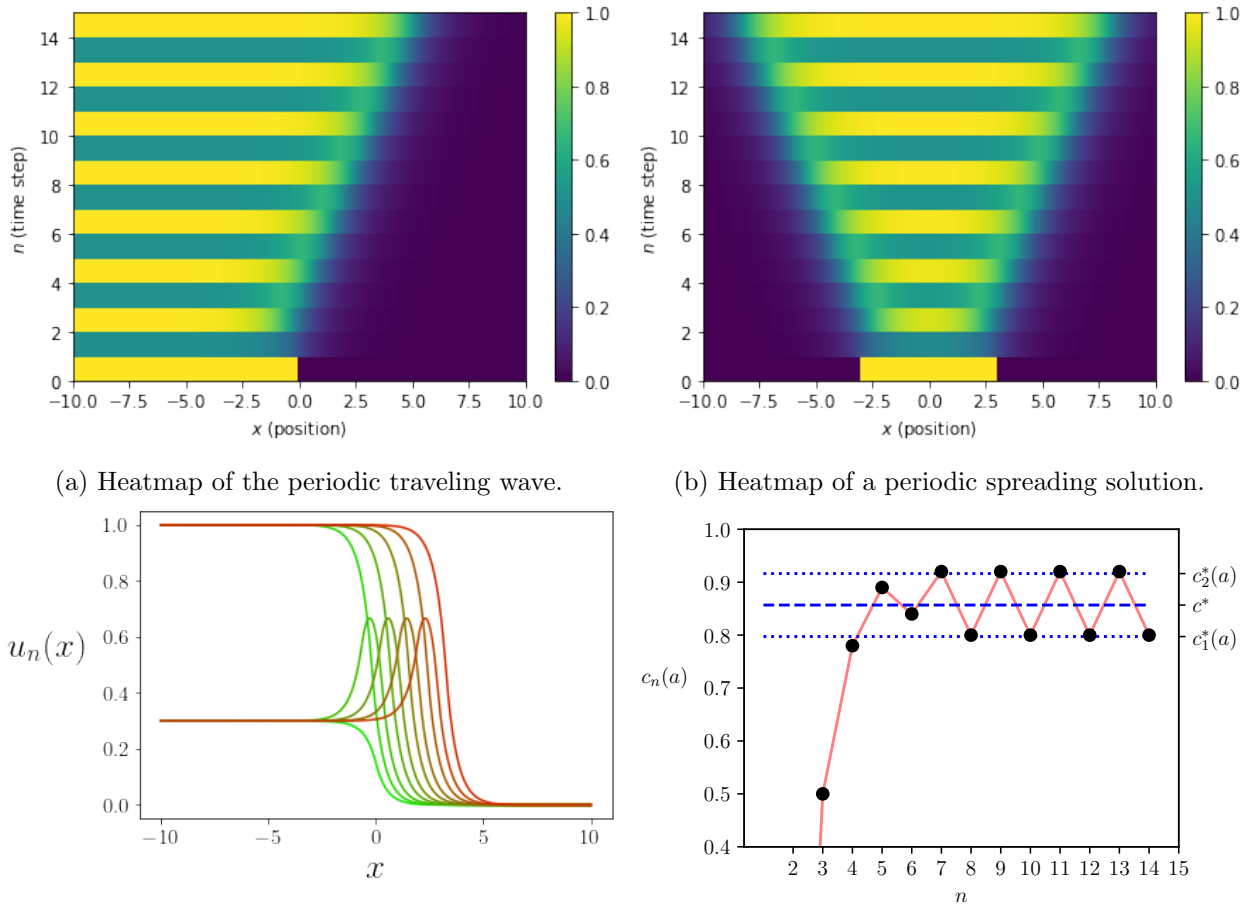
Figure 3 shows the results of a numerical simulation with growth parameters were $a = 0.3$, $m = 0.5$, and $b = 0.8$ with the Laplace dispersal kernel, for an average spreading speed of $c^* = \frac{1}{2}\ln\frac{22}{9}$. Figures 3a and 3b show heatmaps of the periodic traveling wave solution and a spreading solution with compactly supported initial condition. Figure 3c shows a numerical simulation of the periodic traveling wave solution, while Figure 3d shows the asymptotic convergence of the intermediate wave-speed sequence $c_n(\ell)$, evaluated at the Allee threshold $\ell = a$.

3.2 Uniform kernel

The uniform dispersal kernel is given by

$$k(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{2}, & \text{if } |x| \le 1, \\ 0, & \text{if } |x| > 1. \end{cases} \tag{3.8}$$

Like the previous example, $k(x)$ is symmetric around zero. We can verify (H4) by letting $A > B$ and $\lambda \in (0,1)$ and defining $f(x) = k(x-A) - \lambda k(x-B)$. There are two cases:



(a) Heatmap of the periodic traveling wave.

(b) Heatmap of a periodic spreading solution.

(c) Population density curve of the periodic traveling wave.

(d) Time series plot of intermediate spreading speed.

Figure 3: Heatmaps of (a) the periodic traveling wave, and (b) the corresponding spreading solution with compactly supported initial data, and Laplace dispersal kernel. In figure (d), the horizontal blue lines correspond to the theoretical values derived in Corollary 2.3.

Case 1. If $|A - B| < 2$, then

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 0, & x \leq B - 1, \\ -\frac{\lambda}{2}, & B - 1 < x \leq A - 1, \\ \frac{1-\lambda}{2}, & A - 1 < x < B + 1, \\ \frac{1}{2}, & B + 1 \leq x < A + 1 \\ 0, & x \geq A + 1. \end{cases}$$

Case 2. If $|A - B| \geq 2$, then

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 0, & x \leq B - 1, \\ -\frac{\lambda}{2}, & B - 1 < x < B + 1, \\ 0, & B + 1 \leq x \leq A - 1, \\ \frac{1}{2}, & A - 1 < x < A + 1 \\ 0, & x \geq A + 1. \end{cases}$$

In both cases, the number of sign changes is exactly 1. To extend this argument to (H5), observe that since $k(x)$ has compact support, we have

$$\begin{aligned} f(x-r) - f(r-x) &= k(x-r-A) - \lambda k(x-r-B) - k(x+r+A) + \lambda k(x+r+B) \\ &= \begin{cases} -f(r-x), & x < -r+1, \\ 0, & -r+1 \le x \le r-1, \\ f(x-r), & x > r-1, \end{cases} \end{aligned}$$

for sufficiently large r.

The alternating wave profiles are given by

$$w_1(x) = \begin{cases} 1, & x \in (-\infty, -1), \\ \frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{2}x, & x \in [-1, 1], \\ 0, & x \in (1, \infty), \end{cases} \tag{3.9}$$

and

$$w_2(x + c^*) = \begin{cases} m, & x \in (-\infty, -2b), \\ \frac{1-m}{2}x + m + b - mb, & x \in [-2b, -2a), \\ -\frac{m}{2}x + m + b - mb - a, & x \in [-2a, 2-2b), \\ -\frac{1}{2}x - a + 1, & x \in [2-2b, 2-2a], \\ 0, & x \in (2+2a, \infty), \end{cases} \tag{3.10}$$

with

$$c^* = \begin{cases} 1 - 2a, & \text{if } a \le b/2, \\ 1 - b + \frac{b-2a}{m}, & \text{if } a > b/2. \end{cases} \tag{3.11}$$

w_2 has a global maximum at $x = -2a$ so that $||w_2||_\infty = m + (b-a)(1-m)$. Thus, a sufficient condition for the existence of the periodic traveling wave is $w_2(-2a) = m + (b-a)(1-m) < b$.

The intermediate wave speeds are given by

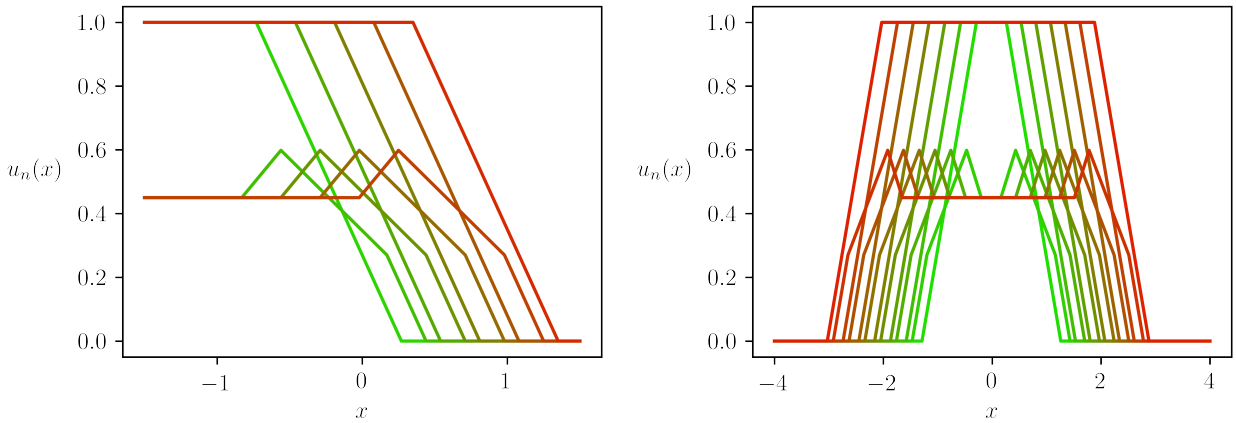
$$c_1^*(\ell) = 1 - 2\ell \tag{3.12}$$

and

$$c_2^*(\ell) = \begin{cases} 1 - 4a + 2\ell, & a \le b/2, \\ 1 - 2b + \frac{2b-4a}{m} + 2\ell, & a > b/2, \end{cases} \tag{3.13}$$

for $0 < \ell < m + (b-a)(1-m)$. By evaluating the intermediate wave speeds at $\ell = a$, we obtain $c_1^*(a) = c_2^*(a)$ if $a \le b/2$, and $|c_1^*(a) - c_2^*(a)| = 2(2a-b)(\frac{1-m}{m}) > 0$ if $a > b/2$. So for $a > b/2$, the traveling wave is periodic with two different intermediate wave speeds. Furthermore, the difference between these two intermediate speeds is increasing with respect to a, the Allee threshold, and decreasing with respect to b, the overcompensation threshold.

Figure 4a depicts the periodic traveling wave solution (2.4) with the uniform kernel with growth parameters are $a = 0.325$, $b = 0.6$, and $m = 0.45$. The mean spreading speed can be analytically calculated as $c^* = \frac{13}{45}$. The intermediate speeds are $c_1^*(a) = \frac{7}{20}$ and $c_2^*(a) = \frac{41}{180}$. Figure 4b demonstrates the spreading phenomena with initial domain rize $r_0 = 1$. Since our uniform kernel is compact with support $[-1, 1]$, a sufficient lower bound on the initial domain size is $r_0 \ge 3$.



(a) Heaviside initial data.

(b) Compact initial data ($r_0 = 1$).

Figure 4: Population density plots of (a) the periodic traveling wave, and (b) a spreading solution with uniform dispersal.

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